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PICKS FOR
6
TASKS

THE AI MODEL TASK CHART

Which AI should I use?

A task-first cheat sheet for Gemini, Claude, ChatGPT and Manus — designed for ordinary work, not benchmark watching.

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Which AI should I use? — tasks 1 to 3

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THE RULE

Match the tool shape and the model level to the task. Chatbot or agent first — then the lightest model that can do the job well.

Where you "live" matters.
If two tools are close, use the one that already has your files, context and workflow.

What are you doing? Start with the job, not the brand.

Task	Gemini Google	Claude Anthropic	ChatGPT OpenAI	Manus Autonomous agent
1. Quick answer or short rewrite Explain a term, tidy a paragraph, brainstorm ten names.	**Gemini 3.8 Flash** Low Fast workhorse; no need for Argon.	**Claude Haiku 5.5** Fastest tier Best fit for brief, routine work.	**ChatGPT** Instant Flip on auto-switching in settings if you want it to step up on its own.	**Manus agent** Skip A chatbot is faster and cheaper here.
2. Polished email, post or short document Client note, LinkedIn post, two-page briefing.	**Gemini 3.8 Flash** Medium Good balance of speed and judgment.	**Claude Sonnet 5.5** Medium The everyday writing and document choice.	**ChatGPT** Medium Use High only for a difficult audience or argument.	**Manus agent** Skip A chatbot is faster and cheaper here.
3. Summarize or compare long files A 50-page report, contracts, several PDFs.	**Gemini 4 Argon** Medium Use High when details conflict or the stakes rise.	**Claude Sonnet 5.5** Medium Move to Opus for nuanced cross-document judgment.	**ChatGPT** High Ask for citations to the uploaded pages.	**Manus agent** Skip Possible, but a chatbot is faster and cheaper.

Tasks 4 to 6 — choose the mode

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Choose the mode that fits the work. Use deeper reasoning for research, decisions and complex builds — not by default.

Tasks 4–6	Gemini Google	Claude Anthropic	ChatGPT OpenAI	Manus Autonomous agent
4. Research a current topic Market scan, policy update, competitor review.	**Deep Research** Research mode Use the research workflow, not a normal chat.	**Research + Sonnet 5.5** Medium Opus High for disputed or high-stakes synthesis.	**Deep research** Research mode Let the product route the underlying model.	**Manus 2.0** Agent mode Strong pick — runs the whole investigation end to end.
5. Analyze data or make a difficult decision Spreadsheet patterns, scenario plan, strategy choice.	**Gemini 4 Argon** High For multi-step reasoning and careful checking.	**Claude Opus 5.5** High Use Sonnet Medium for routine analysis.	**ChatGPT** High Pro Standard/Extended if available and justified.	**Manus 2.0** Agent mode Strong pick — plans, analyzes and delivers the work.
6. Build a website, app, game or prototype Business site, interactive dashboard, playable demo, 3D scene.	**Gemini 4 Argon** Medium Use High for complex logic; Antigravity is the natural workspace.	**Claude Sonnet 5.5** High Use Artifacts or Claude Code; Opus for hard architecture.	**GPT-6.1 Sol** High · Work/Codex Astra/Pro Extended for the hardest builds, if available.	**Manus 2.0** Agent mode Describe it and let the agent build it start to finish.
Flat images Different tool lane	**Gemini:** Nano Banana 2.1 for everyday image generation and editing; Pro when exact text or layout matters most.	**Claude:** no native flat-image generator. Use Claude to develop the concept, prompt, SVG or interactive artifact.	**ChatGPT:** Images 2.5 for generation and editing. In the API, Flare favors speed; Sunburst favors precision.	**Manus:** describe the site, app or scene and let the agent build it start to finish.

Important: model names, access and settings vary by plan, region and rollout. Treat this as a starting rule, then test the result on your own task.

Selected official sources: Gemini 3.8 Flash · Gemini 4 Argon · Nano Banana 2.1 · Gemini Deep Research · Claude 5.5 family · Claude Research · ChatGPT picker · ChatGPT research · GPT-6 Astra · GPT-6 family · Images 2.5 · Manus.